

THE QUESTION

How can Army use AI to increase operational effectiveness?

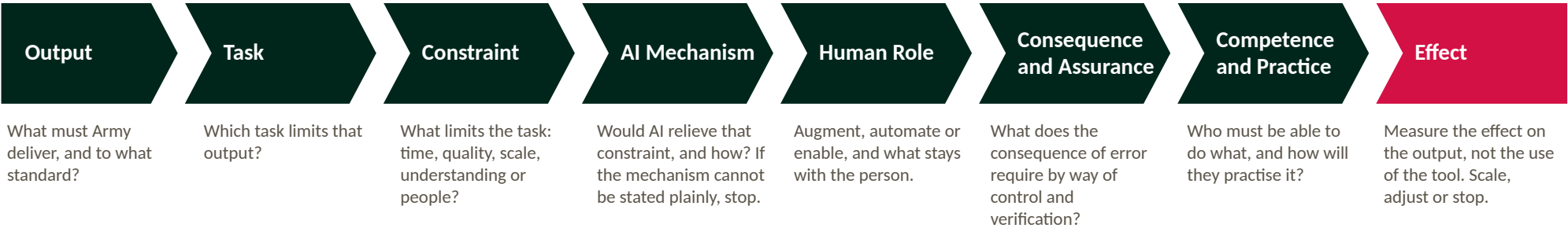
THE ANSWER

Army should use AI where it relieves a material constraint on military output in ways that convert into capability.

A small army that cannot fight when the tools are denied has not gained effectiveness. It has moved its dependence.

The Framework

Reason from the output to the tool. Close on measured effect.



An application that cannot answer Constraint and Mechanism is novelty. Measure the effect on the output, not the use of the tool.

CONSEQUENCE AND ASSURANCE ARE SETTLED BY A SINGLE TEST

Assurance increases with consequence, irreversibility and difficulty of verification

Where AI Creates Advantage

Five areas survive the test, ordered by the strength of the mechanism and how much of it Army controls.

Planning and staff work	Intelligence and readiness	Generating trained people	Learning and adaptation	Administrative load
Faster planning; broader options; staff time returned to judgement	Scale; understanding sooner, from more	Adaptive competence at scale; readiness	Speed of institutional learning	Human capacity
AUGMENT	AUGMENT; ENABLE FOR READINESS	AUGMENT AND ENABLE	ENABLE	AUTOMATE
Decides, accepts risk, verifies	Assesses sources, judges, decides	Coaches, assesses, assures the standard	Validates, decides what changes	Owns what is signed

Deliberately not prioritised: autonomous targeting, and personnel analytics ahead of the data to support them.

ARMY PEOPLE

Everyone understands it • Many employ it • Leaders govern it • A few specialise in it

The Principles

- 1

Effect first

Adopted where it improves an Army output, and measured against it.
- 2

Task before tool

From the output and its constraint to the application, never the reverse.
- 3

The commander owns it

AI advises; it does not decide where consequence is high. Verify what you use. You own what you sign.
- 4

Assurance by consequence

More control where error costs more, lasts longer or is harder to check.
- 5

Competence before dependence

No one relies on a tool for a skill they must perform without it. Competence comes from practice against real tasks.

Priority Actions

- 1

Own it

Assign accountability for AI in Army; set risk appetite by consequence, so low-consequence use is enabled by default.
- 2

Prove effect in three places

Bounded, measured trials: planning and orders in a headquarters; training design in Army Training Group; readiness data. Stop what does not work.
- 3

Train it through the approach

AI competence built into individual training against real tasks, with tool-denied assurance of core skills. Instructors first.
- 4

Improve the data

Readiness and training data are likely to constrain the highest-value applications Army controls directly.
- 5

Compress the lessons cycle

From observation to updated training and tactics at a pace the force can act on.